

The Forest Mystery

A Story About Producers, Consumers, and Decomposers



Emma and Noah loved exploring nature.

One Saturday morning, they joined a forest walk led by Dr. Kim, an ecologist who studied plants and animals.

As they walked through Evergreen Forest, Emma noticed leaves covering the ground.

There were fallen branches, old tree trunks, and even a few dead plants.

“But the forest doesn’t look messy,” Emma said.

“Who cleans all this up?”

Dr. Kim smiled.

“That’s today’s mystery.”

“Let’s discover the three important groups of living things that keep every forest alive.”



❖ The Food Makers ❖



Their first stop was a sunny meadow.

Bright green grass, tall trees, and colorful wildflowers stretched in every direction.

Dr. Kim pointed to a large oak tree.

“These are called producers,” she said.

“They use sunlight, water, and carbon dioxide to make their own food through photosynthesis.”

Noah looked around.

“So every plant is like its own tiny kitchen?”

“Exactly,” Dr. Kim laughed.

“And almost every living thing depends on plants for food.”



The Hungry Consumers



Next, they heard a rustle in the bushes.

A rabbit hopped out and nibbled on some green leaves.

“That rabbit is a consumer,” Dr. Kim said.

“It can’t make its own food,
so it eats plants to get energy.”

Soon, a bird flew down and caught a bug.

“Some animals eat plants,” Dr. Kim explained,
“and some animals eat other animals.”

Noah nodded. “So they all need food to live!”

“Yes,” Dr. Kim smiled. “Consumers help move energy
from one living thing to another.”



❧ Nature's Recycling Team ❧



A little farther down the trail, they found a fallen log.
It was covered with tiny mushrooms.

“Who are these?” Emma asked.

Dr. Kim smiled. “These are decomposers!”

“They break down dead plants and animals
into tiny pieces.”

“They return nutrients to the soil,” she continued,
“so new plants can grow.”

Noah picked up a dry leaf. “So nothing is wasted?”

“Exactly!” Dr. Kim said. “Decomposers are nature’s recyclers.”



Everything Works Together



Dr. Kim drew a big circle in the dirt.

“Plants make food. Animals eat plants or other animals.

“Decomposers break down dead things and return nutrients to the soil.”

This cycle keeps the forest healthy and full of life.”

Emma looked around. The sunlight lit up the trees.

A cool breeze blew through the leaves.

Birds sang. The rabbit hopped away.

“Everything in the forest had a job,” Dr. Kim said,

“and when each part does its job,
nature stays in perfect balance.”

Emma and Noah smiled.

The mystery was solved—the forest never wastes anything!



Science Element



Every forest has three important groups of living things.
They all depend on each other and keep the forest healthy!



PRODUCERS

Plants are producers.
They use sunlight,
water, and air to make
their own food through
photosynthesis.
They are the food
makers of the forest.



CONSUMERS

Animals are consumers.
They cannot make their
own food, so they eat
plants or other animals
to get energy.
They help move energy
through the forest.



Herbivores
(eat plants)



Carnivores
(eat animals)



Omnivores
(eat plants and animals)



DECOMPOSERS

Fungi, bacteria, and tiny
organisms are decomposers.
They break down dead
plants and animals into
tiny pieces and return
nutrients to the soil.
This helps new plants grow!



PRODUCERS make food. **CONSUMERS** eat to get energy.
DECOMPOSERS recycle nutrients.

Together, they form a cycle that keeps the forest alive, healthy,
and full of life—where nothing is wasted!

